at the West Berlin funeral ceremony commemorating the death of victims on 17 June, Adenauer pointed out that their uprising had demonstrated before the whole world that force cannot break the will for freedom. Soon after, Ernst Reuter, West Berlin's charismatic mayor, renamed the Charlottenbuger Chausee – a long thoroughfare cutting through the Tiergarten to the Brandenburg Gate – 'Strasse des 17 Juni', as a memorial to those who died.

Oddly enough, the great irony of the unrest was that it secured Ulbricht's grip on power. Though its causes remain clouded, Ulbricht dubbed it a 'fascist coup attempt' and blamed 'saboteurs of peace'. He claimed the disorder was systematically provoked and organised by provocateurs from West Berlin and members of a clandestine American network. In support, socialist media ran a flood of stories transmitting the same line. 'It is known that in West Berlin, controlled by the Americans,' Radio Prague noted, 'there are a number of espionage agencies and fascist organisations which organise sabotage and terrorism in the German Democratic Republic in return for American dollars. Adenauer turned to these professional criminals.'8

Shrill propaganda was backed up by supportive articles from the likes of Kurt Bartel, secretary of the Writers' Union and Ulbricht apparatchik. Feigning indignation, he claimed to have been 'embarrassed by the immaturity of the workers', and penned a booklet entitled: How Ashamed I Am, addressed to builders, painters and carpenters. 'Repairing destroyed houses is easy,' he emotively explained. 'Restoring destroyed trust is very, very difficult.' He went on to thank the Red Army for wiping the city clean and blamed the uprising on:

scum from the other side [West] who stole on silver bicycles through the city, like swallows before the rain. But you could go to sleep in your beds by nine that night, like good children. For you and for the peace of the world, the Soviet army and the comrades of the People's Police kept watch. Are you not ashamed, as I am? For you will have to build much and well